

Using these terms, we can state the Principle of Sufficient Reason as follows:

possible

necessary

contingent

Now recall Leibniz's central question:

Leibniz thinks that, once we see that the PSR is true,
we can show (1) that this question must have an
answer, and (2) that the only satisfactory answer to this
question will imply the existence of God.

Let's see why he thought that.

“Why is there any world at all,
and why is it the way that it is?”



Leibniz's
argument



the
PSR



objections
to the
PSR

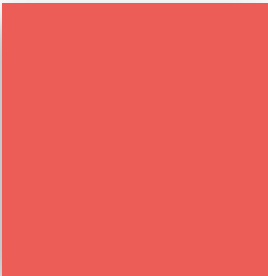
The principle of sufficient reason

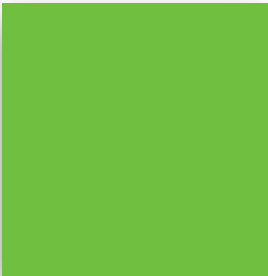
Every contingent fact has an
explanation.

follows:

Using these terms, we can state the Principle of Sufficient Reason as







we can show(1) that this question must have an

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answer, and (2) that the only satisfactory answer to this

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“Why is there any word at all;

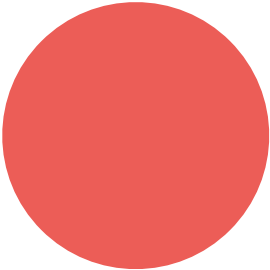
and why is it the way that it is?"

... we cannot find in any of the individual things, or even in the entire collection and series of things, a sufficient reason for why they exist.

Let us suppose that a book on the elements of geometry has always existed, one copy always made from another. It is obvious that although we can explain a present copy of the book from the previous book from which it was copied, this will never lead us to a complete explanation, no matter how many books back we go, since we can always wonder why there have been such books.

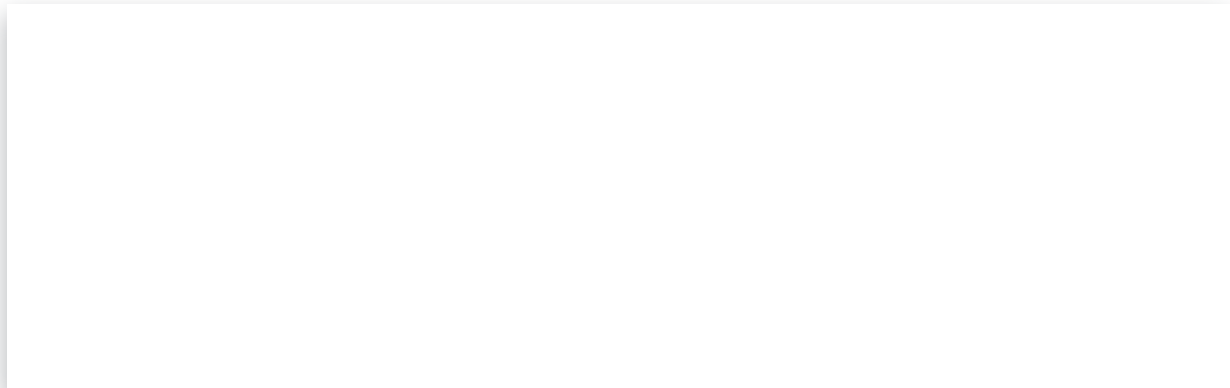
What is true of these books is also true of the different states of the world ... however far back we might go into previous states, we will never find in those states a complete explanation for why there is a world at all, and why it is the way it is.







objections
to the
PSR

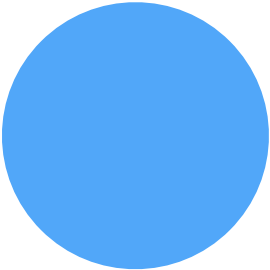


The principle of sufficient reason

Every intelligent fact has an



expiration.





simply be some event, like the Big Bang, which is not a plausible candidate to

cause exists, then God exists: the objection was that the first cause could

be Good.

Last time we considered an objection to Aquinas' assumption that if a first



Leibniz's
argument



the
PSR





Leibniz's
argument

